NAM: GENESIS

The rapid decolonization process that followed after the Second World War brought into existence numerous states in Africa, Asia and the Caribbean which were mostly small or middle-sized and were underdeveloped and politically weak. They faced twin tasks of nation-building as well as tackling the internal dissenting forces within their societies. Alongside they had a Herculean task of coping up with underdevelopment and working towards development. It is these nations whose governments came together under the umbrella of the NAM.

Post-Second World War also witnessed the outbreak of Cold War resulting in the hostilities of the two major powers, the United States and the Soviet Union. The Cold War was further fuelled when the USA adopted a policy of containment of Communism throughout the world, as the USSR was doing the same by giving support to the national liberation movements. The ultimate result was military pacts and counter pacts, an increase in arms race, gradual polarization of the world into different blocs, and the threat of nuclear war, which could result in the total annihilation of mankind. The newly independent states that wanted to tide over their own problems of development and shared a similar kind of exploitative colonial past, wanted to belong to neither of the camps and envisioned a position of neutrality—non-alignment. The NAM originated under the leadership of Jawaharlal Nehru (India), Marshal Tito (Yugoslavia), Kusno Sukarno (Indonesia), Kwame Nkrumah (Ghana) and Gamal Abdel Nasser (Egypt). They forged a strong coalition of states from Asia, Africa, Europe, The Arab World and Latin America and the Caribbean.

The rationale behind the adoption of the policy of non-alignment by the developing countries reflects numerous objectives, each differing from one state to the other. For instance, in the case of India, her foreign policy objectives rested on the pillars of peace, freedom from colonialism, racial equality and non-alignment, which were very much grounded in her experiences of colonial rule and her freedom struggle against British colonialism. The Cold War that emerged immediately after the conclusion of the Second World War and the